



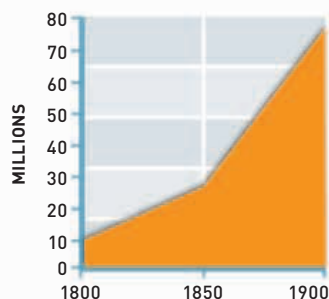
This illustration shows the storming of Beijing by the international force that arrived to fight the anti-Western attacks during the Boxer uprising.

THE GROWING PRESENCE OF WESTERNERS

—especially Christian missionaries—in China was starting to cause public anger. This eventually erupted into the **Boxer Rebellion**, which was a peasant uprising that aimed to eject all foreigners from China. The group behind the attacks had earlier founded a secret society known as the “Righteous and Harmonious Fists,” hence the sobriquet “Boxer.” Members of the group were also found among the Qing court, and so the movement’s violent attacks on foreigners and Chinese converts to Christianity were officially sanctioned. An international **relief force** of 2,100 troops from Britain, France, Italy, Germany, Russia, Japan, and the US was eventually sent to the port of Tianjin in June 1900, but the Boxers

continued to burn down churches and kill Christians. After the international troops seized several forts, the empress dowager **Tz’u Hsi** (1835–1908) ordered all foreigners to be killed, and many foreign ministers were murdered. After the arrival of reinforcements, the international force made its way to Beijing, which it captured. The empress dowager fled, and a truce was negotiated with the imperial princes in September 1901. This put an end to the violence and provided for reparations to be made. While these events were taking place, the **Russians** took the opportunity to occupy southern **Manchuria**, which bordered southern Russia.

In Africa, mining began in **Katanga**, a southern region of the present-day Democratic Republic of the Congo. The discovery of rich **copper** deposits—as well as other minerals, including zinc, cobalt, and tin—led to the rapid establishment by Europeans of mining infrastructure, such as railroad lines, and towns began to spring up in this region. As mining companies proliferated, Katanga was soon one of the most highly industrialized areas



Growing nation

Thanks to decades of immigration, the population of the US had soared, reaching more than 75 million by 1900.

of the Congo, but the many Africans employed performed the dirty and dangerous work in the mines for very little pay.

Meanwhile, in West Africa, British troops faced a rebellion by the **Asante**, which took eight months to subdue. Unrest in the **Gold Coast** region continued throughout the following decade as Africans continued to resist British rule.

Across the Atlantic, in the US, decades of **immigration** had caused the country’s population to nearly double. There were around 35.5 million people living in the US in 1870, and by 1900 that number had reached more than 75 million. Much of this growth had been in **urban areas**—some 40 percent of the population were living in cities rather than settling in rural communities.

Going underground

A Metro sign built into a lamp-post in Paris, France. The first underground train line was opened in Paris in 1900.



Queen Victoria’s funeral procession makes its way through London.

THE MANY COLONIES THAT HAD BEEN FOUNDED IN AUSTRALIA

Victoria, New South Wales, Queensland, South Australia, Western Australia, and Tasmania—ushered in a new era on January 1, after the drafting and approval of the **constitution** and official establishment of the Commonwealth of Australia.

A few weeks later, Great Britain and its colonies mourned the loss of **Queen Victoria**, who died on January 22. She had ruled the nation and empire for 63 years, making her reign the longest by a British monarch. Her son, **Edward VII** (1841–1910), took the throne, and the largely peaceful—though very socially stratified—period under his rule was known as the **Edwardian era**.



Commonwealth stamp

This stamp showing Queen Victoria is from Australia, which brought its colonies into a federation the same year the monarch died.



Prince Saud Ibn Abdul-Aziz, the first monarch of the modern Saudi state.

THE SOUTH AFRICAN, OR ANGLO-BOER, WAR

between Boer settlers and the British ended on May 31. The end of the war was hastened when the British adopted a “scorched earth” policy, which involved destroying crops and livestock to limit Boer supplies. The dispossessed Boer women and children were rounded up into concentration camps. Under the **Treaty of Vereeniging**, the Boers were forced to recognize British sovereignty in South Africa, ending the independence of the Orange Free State and the South African Republic. The whole territory was now under British control.

Meanwhile, **Ibn Saud** (c. 1880–1953) recaptured the Saud dynasty’s formal capital of Riyadh, after decades of civil war (see 1843). In 1901, Saud, who was living in Kuwait, set out to take back the territory he had been forced to leave by the rival Rashids. He and his men reached Riyadh in January 1902 and crept into town, waiting to ambush the Rashidi governor the following morning. Soon Saud had taken the city and the territory, with the help of a growing number of supporters. This became the kingdom of **Saudi Arabia** in 1932, and it remains under the Saud family’s rule to the present day.

On the Caribbean island of Martinique, the violent eruption of **Mount Pelée** killed around 30,000 people and destroyed the port of Saint-Pierre on May 8. The volcano had previously erupted in 1792 and 1851, but on nowhere near the scale of the 1902 eruption.

January 24 Second Anglo-Boer War: British attempt to relieve Ladysmith at the Battle of Spion Kop ends in defeat

Nigeria becomes British protectorate

April 22 Battle of Kousséri: the French take control of Chad after defeating and killing warlord Rabih az-Zubayr

April 30 Hawaii becomes an official US territory

June 5 British soldiers take Pretoria in Second Anglo-Boer War

May 18 Tonga becomes a British protectorate

July 19 First subway line opens in Paris

July 2 First zeppelin flight takes place in Germany

August 14 Boxer Rebellion in China: international forces invade Beijing to free European hostages

October Russian occupation of Manchuria

January 22 Queen Victoria dies; Edward VII (1841–1910) ascends British throne

June 11 New Zealand annexes the Cook Islands

September 14 Theodore “Teddy” Roosevelt (1858–1919) elected US president

September 25 Britain annexes Asante kingdom (part of Ghana)

February 15 Berlin U-Bahn underground opens

May 20 Cuba becomes independent of US

May 31 End of Second Anglo-Boer War with Treaty of Vereeniging

December 10 Egypt opens first Aswan Dam